



“I have come to believe that this is a mighty continent previously unknown.”

CHRISTOPHER COLUMBUS, *JOURNAL OF HIS THIRD VOYAGE*, 1498

1494 French King Charles VIII invades Italy and initiates a series of wars (the Italian Wars) that last for 65 years

1495 Syphilis arrives in Europe; an epidemic breaks out among French soldiers at Naples

1497 Italian mariner John Cabot, sailing from Bristol, explores the North American coast

1499



1492

FALL OF GRANADA

The Emirate of Granada was the last Muslim state on the Iberian peninsula. After ten years of campaigns by Spain's Catholic Monarchs, Granada surrendered to the Christians in January 1492. The surrender terms guaranteed the Muslims religious toleration, but they soon came under pressure to convert to Christianity. Those who refused were driven into exile.

◀ The Alhambra fortress and palace at Granada

1481-1520 PORTUGUESE EXPLORATION



Under King John II (r. 1481-1495), Portuguese sailors resumed far-reaching voyages of discovery begun by Prince Henry the Navigator.

1488 Bartolomeu Dias sails around the southern tip of Africa at the Cape of Good Hope, showing the route to India.



1497-98 Vasco da Gama commands a fleet that sails to India, via south Africa, and back, the longest oceanic voyage to that date.



1500 Pedro Cabral leads a fleet of 13 ships and makes landfall in northeast Brazil, claiming the territory for the Portuguese crown.



1519 Ferdinand Magellan sails from Spain to Asia across the Pacific. One ship completes a voyage around the globe.